

involved in lengthy battles with Protestant princes in the empire, and in wars with France, to the neglect of Spain.

1519–24 **Hernán Cortés** conquers Aztec Empire for Spain.

1520–22 **Comunero popular** uprising in northern Spain is crushed.

1531–35 **Francisco Pizarro** conquers Inca empire for Spain.

1538 **Spanish control** is established in Colombia with the foundation of Santa Fé de Bogotá.

1554 **Philip, heir to the throne**, marries Mary Tudor, queen of England, and is king of England until her death in 1558. Ascends the Spanish throne as Philip II in 1556.

1556 **Charles V abdicates**, and the Holy Roman Empire is divided between Austrian Habsburg and Spanish lands. His brother Ferdinand rules the Austrian Habsburg lands and becomes Holy Roman Emperor, while his son Philip II rules Spain along with Sardinia, Naples and Sicily, the Duchy of Milan, Franch-Comté, and the Netherlands and Luxembourg. Charles retires to a monastery in Spain.

1559 **Treaty of Cateau-Cambrésis** ends Italian wars with France.

1561 **Madrid** is established as the Spanish capital.

1563–84 **Philip II builds** the vast palace of el Escorial, outside Madrid.

1565 **Spanish build forts** in Florida to defend Spanish bullion fleets sailing home from Mexico and Panama.

1566 **Protestant Dutch rise** up against Spanish rule, and are helped by Elizabeth I of England.

1568–71 **Moriscos** (Moors converted to Christianity) revolt in southern Spain but are crushed by Philip II.

1571 **Spanish capture** Manila and it becomes capital of Spanish Philippines.

1574 **The fall of** Spanish-controlled Tunis to an Ottoman fleet ends Spanish hopes of maintaining a significant military presence in North Africa. Tunis was first recaptured by the Ottomans in 1569, but recaptured by the Spanish in 1572, only to be lost again two years later.

1578 **Spanish troops** reconquer most of southern Netherlands.

1579 **Northern provinces of** the Netherlands formally unite under the Union of Utrecht to fight Spanish rule.

1580 **Portugal comes under** the control of the Spanish crown after the death of the childless king, Henrique. Philip II invades to enforce his claim, winning the Battle of Alcantara. Spain is now at the height of its imperial power in Europe.



Baroque king

King Philip IV, seen here in a portrait by Diego Velázquez, Spain's outstanding painter of the age, was an active patron of the arts. But during his reign Spain declined as a major European power.

1581 **Spain makes** peace with the Ottoman Turks in the Mediterranean.

1588 **Philip sends** an armada to invade England after its Protestant queen, Elizabeth, executes her Catholic cousin and rival for the throne, Mary, Queen of Scots.

1598 **Death of Philip II**; accession of Philip III.

1609 **Twelve-year truce** is signed between Spain and the United Netherlands.

1618–48 **Period of** the 30 Years War, during which Spain is involved in almost constant warfare in Europe, largely against France and the Protestant rulers of Germany and northern Europe.

1621 **Philip IV becomes king.**

1628 **French offensives begin** against Spanish territories. The French campaigns are directed by Cardinal Richelieu, chief minister to Louis XIII, who sets out to attack and dismember the Habsburg Empire in Europe.

1640 **France supports** rebellions in Portugal and Catalonia against Spanish rule. The subsequent French invasion of Catalonia leads to a long, inconclusive conflict in the region.

1643 **France inflicts major** defeat of Spanish forces at Rocroi in the Spanish Netherlands.

1642 **French capture strategic** naval base of Dunkirk in Spanish Netherlands.

1647 **France encourages** revolt in Naples to weaken Spanish rule in Italy.

1648 **Spain loses Portugal** and the United Provinces at the end of the 30 Years War, marking the beginning of Spain's imperial decline.

1655 **Spain loses** Jamaica to Britain.

1658 **England seizes** Dunkirk from Spain and in 1662 sells it to France.

1659 **Treaty of the Pyrenees** ends lengthy war with France and cedes control of Rousillon to France.

1665 **Philip IV dies** and is succeeded by his only surviving child and heir, the sickly Charles II.

1667 **France starts lengthy** campaign to gain the Spanish Netherlands.

1672 **France attacks** the Netherlands and occupies most of it by 1678.

1688–97 **War of the League of Augsburg:** Spain, Sweden, the Palatinate, Bavaria, and Saxony oppose France.

1701–14 **The War of** the Spanish Succession breaks out after the death of the childless Charles II, the last Habsburg ruler of Spain, in 1700. Louis XIV of France claims the throne for his Bourbon grandson, Philip, while Britain and others propose the Habsburg Archduke Charles of Austria. Spain and its European possessions become a battleground for competing Portuguese, British, French, and Austrian forces. The war is most bitter in Spain itself: pro-Bourbon Castile is pitted against pro-Habsburg Catalonia.

1704 **British seize** Gibraltar and later Menorca.

1710 **Madrid briefly occupied** by the anti-Bourbon alliance.

1713 **Treaty of Utrecht** ends the War of the Spanish Succession. The French Bourbon candidate becomes Philip V of Spain, but renounces any claim to the French throne. Spain loses southern Netherlands, Milan, Naples, and Sardinia to Austria; Britain keeps Gibraltar and

Menorca, and the right to supply slaves to Spain's American colonies. Spain is now a minor power in a Europe dominated by France, Britain, and Austria.

1716 **Spain occupies part** of modern Texas in response to French expansion from Louisiana.

1717 **Philip V of Spain** tries to supplant Austrian rule in the former Spanish possessions in Italy. He is defeated in 1720.

1731–48 **In a complex** diplomatic shuffle with Austria over possessions in Italy, Spain gains Naples, Sicily, and Parma.

1763 **Spain gains all land** west of the Mississippi river from France; it is transferred back to France in 1800.

1778 **Spain gains island** of Fernando Pó in Africa's Gulf of Guinea from Portugal.

1779–83 **After a lengthy siege**, Spain fails to recapture Gibraltar from Britain. In America, Spain regains Florida from the British, acquired in 1763.

1782 **Spain regains Menorca** from Britain, only to lose it again in 1798.

1807 **Napoleon invades Portugal** to force it to accept the continental trading system designed to exclude British goods. The conflict spreads to Spain the next year and Napoleon places his brother Joseph Bonaparte on the throne, thus provoking a Spanish rebellion and British intervention in the Peninsular War. The British evict the French by 1814.

1811–28 **Spain loses most** of its American colonies, keeping just Cuba and Puerto Rico.

1815 **At the Congress of Vienna**, Spain loses all its Italian possessions.

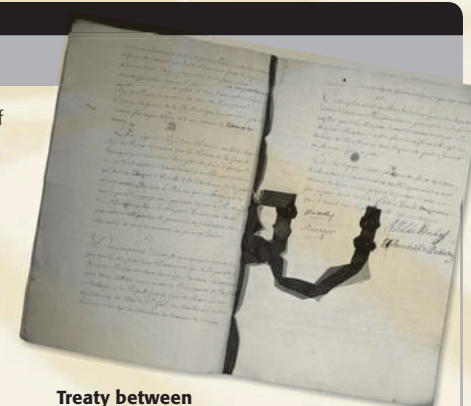
1833–86 **Disputed succession** leads to a series of Carlist revolts and counter-coups, after the conservative Don Carlos is excluded from the succession by his brother Ferdinand VII in 1830.

DECISIVE MOMENT

PEACE OF UTRECHT, 1713

The Peace of Utrecht comprised a series of treaties signed in the Dutch city of Utrecht in 1713. By ending the War of the Spanish Succession, the Peace was one of the great achievements of 18th-century diplomacy.

The treaties were signed by the representatives of Louis XIV of France and Philip V of Spain on the one hand, and of Queen Anne of Britain, the Duke of Savoy, and the United Provinces on the other. The main loser was Spain, whose European empire was carved up: Savoy received Sicily and parts of the Duchy of Milan, while Holy Roman Emperor Charles VI received the Spanish Netherlands, the Kingdom of Naples,



Treaty between Britain and Spain

Sardinia, and most of the Duchy of Milan. By the treaty concluded between Spain and Britain on July 13, 1713 (above), Britain received Gibraltar and Menorca.